erosion as a form of creation

mac waters /// for Fonema Consort

some notes:

death grips
a halved orange made dewy with its own juice,
speckled with luminous partitions of flesh.
a spectre breaking all the new mexican
pottery in the house
baby, fuck your swan song,
this is now a cowboy poem.
indigo moonlight and abhorrently sweet baked beans.
a jazzy apparition
you can grow out of a smattering of freckles.
primordial jungle juice
I'm afraid of the perilous depths of my intuition
and the sweltering of the jungle
in the basement adjacent.
heavy chalk outline around the bulk of it all.
I want to make out and expel all the
dark matter from my body.
you really can't hold a patch of sun
in its shifting place.

but, you see, the lovely thing about sunshine
isn't really that it's warm, but
rather that it frames everything so harmonically
I never draw my gun out first. I have no gun.
I am not a deity. Should I now give you
my rhythm?
do you want my song?
my lyricism?
under the heat of a microscope the cross
section of a pea flower sizzles, nestled
between slides made of blue-green sea
glass. the seaglass, eroded
perfectly by nature
was once a bottle of mineral water which
I had drank greedily, and
smashed against the great face of the sun.
If anything I can give you that,
the vibration of that memory
resonating in infinite temporality

-Lorenzo Barajas (2019)

"erosion as a form of creation" is a fragmentary collage of elements, broken down. the piece is theatrical, it is expansive—enjoy it! commit to each new element fully. instrumentalists are also vocalists and percussionists in the way that we are all vocalists and percussionists. the audience should feel uncomfortable at times (when are they permitted to laugh? when are they permitted to clap?). many performance directives are abstract—let them guide your performance.

let it fall apart where it asks for it. let it deteriorate. let it erode.

notations and symbols:

voice:

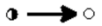
each instrumentalist has two staves: the top (one-line) staff indicates spoken/instructional material, the traditional staff indicates played material—text written above empty vocal staves should be spoken naturally, without rhythm

 spoken normally  perform specified action  vocal fry  as high as possible  spoken into instrument (winds)

winds:

 blow air through instrument  blow air through instrument, percussively producing syllable  rapidly finger random pitches

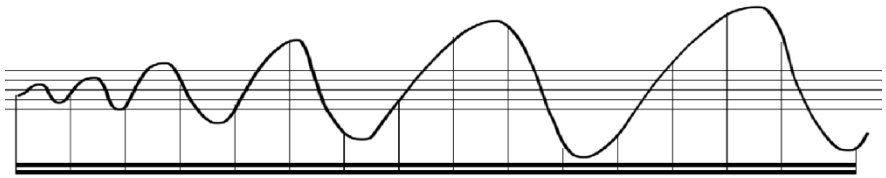
 fl. pizz., produce percussive "t" sound
b. cl. slap tongue blow air through instrument

 transition from some pitch to no pitch

cello:

ord – ordinario
MSP - molto sul ponticello
SP - sul ponticello
ST - sul tasto
MST - molto sul tasto
OP - overpressure
 unmeasured ricochet

other:



wild, free improv following contour of the line

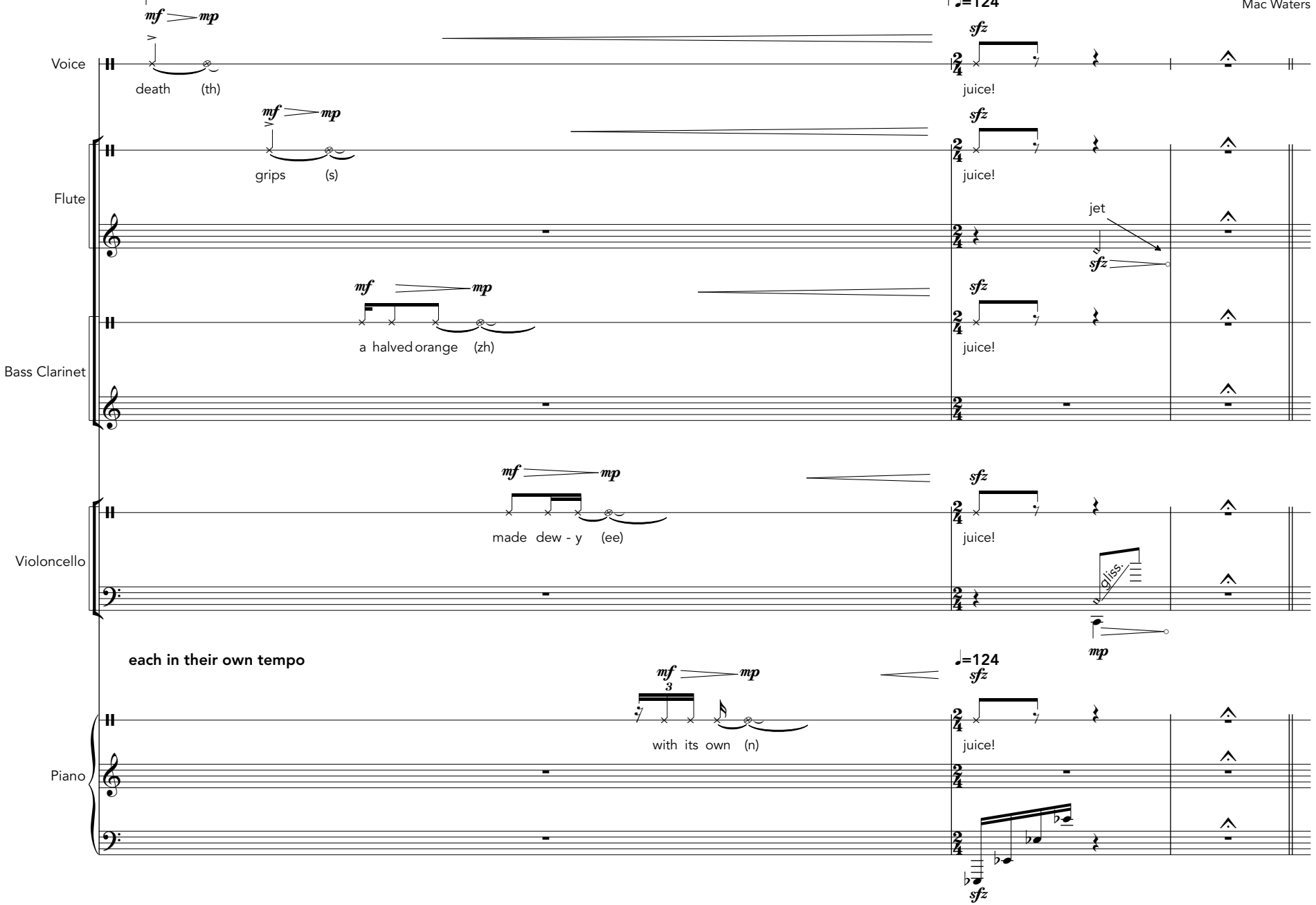
erosion as a form of creation

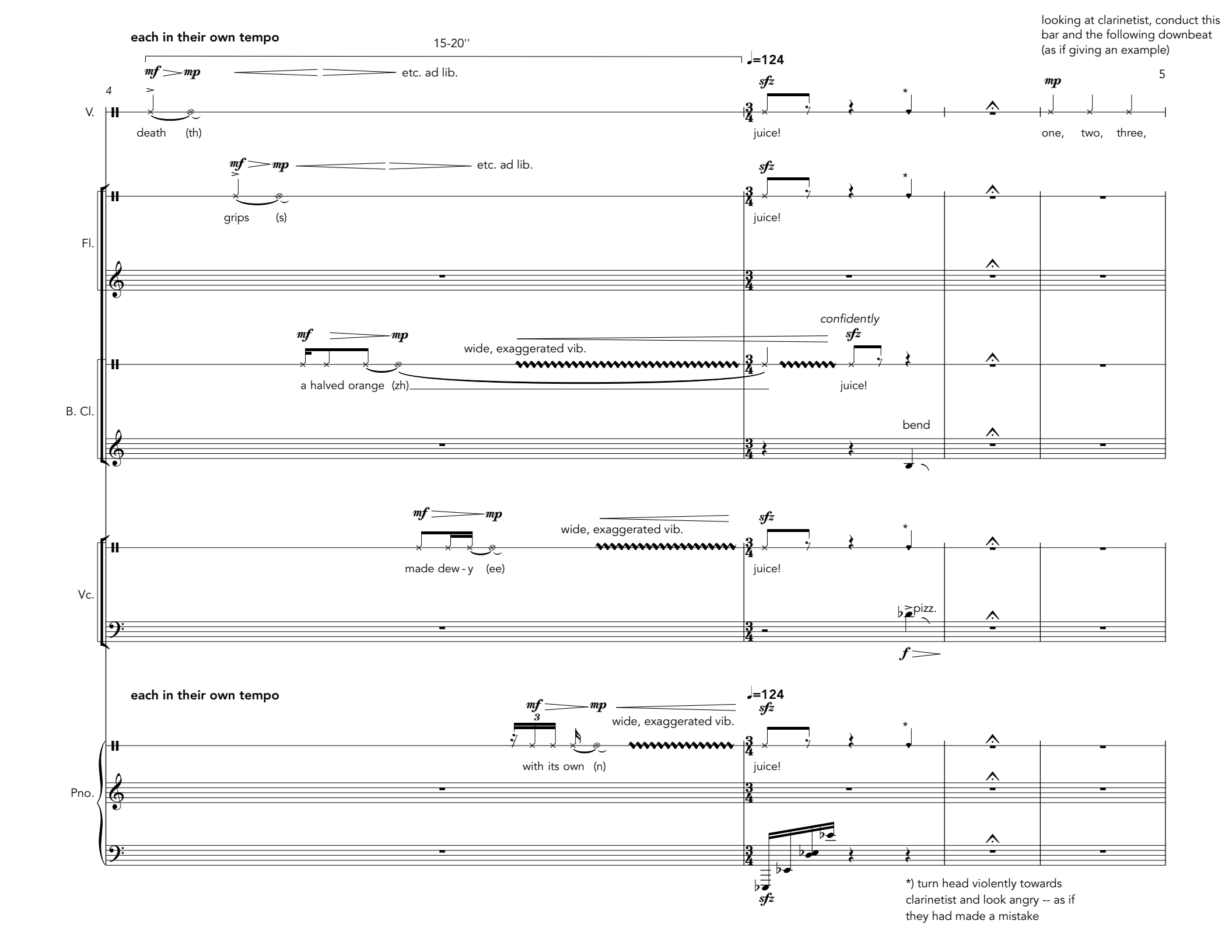
Mac Waters

each in their own tempo

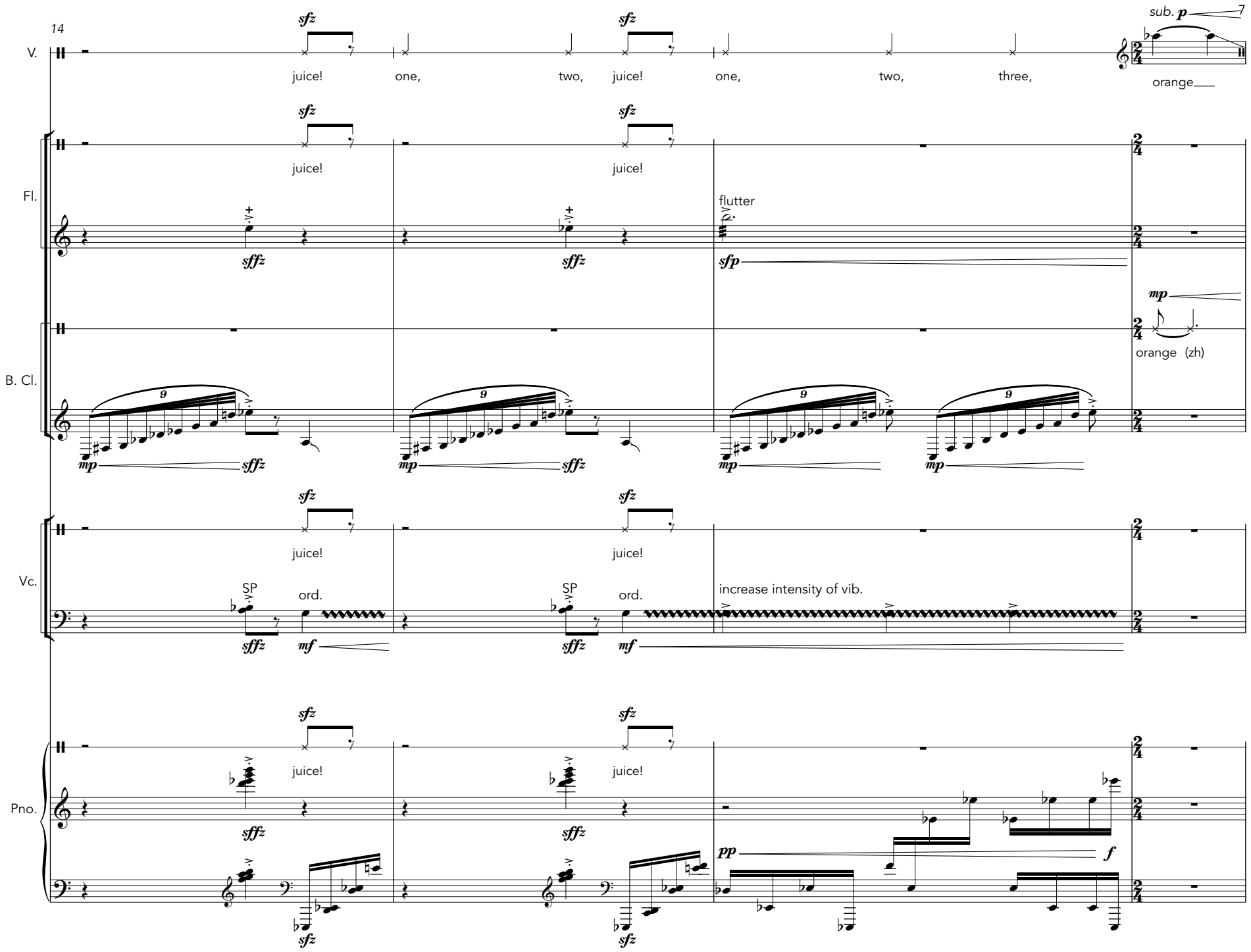
10-15''

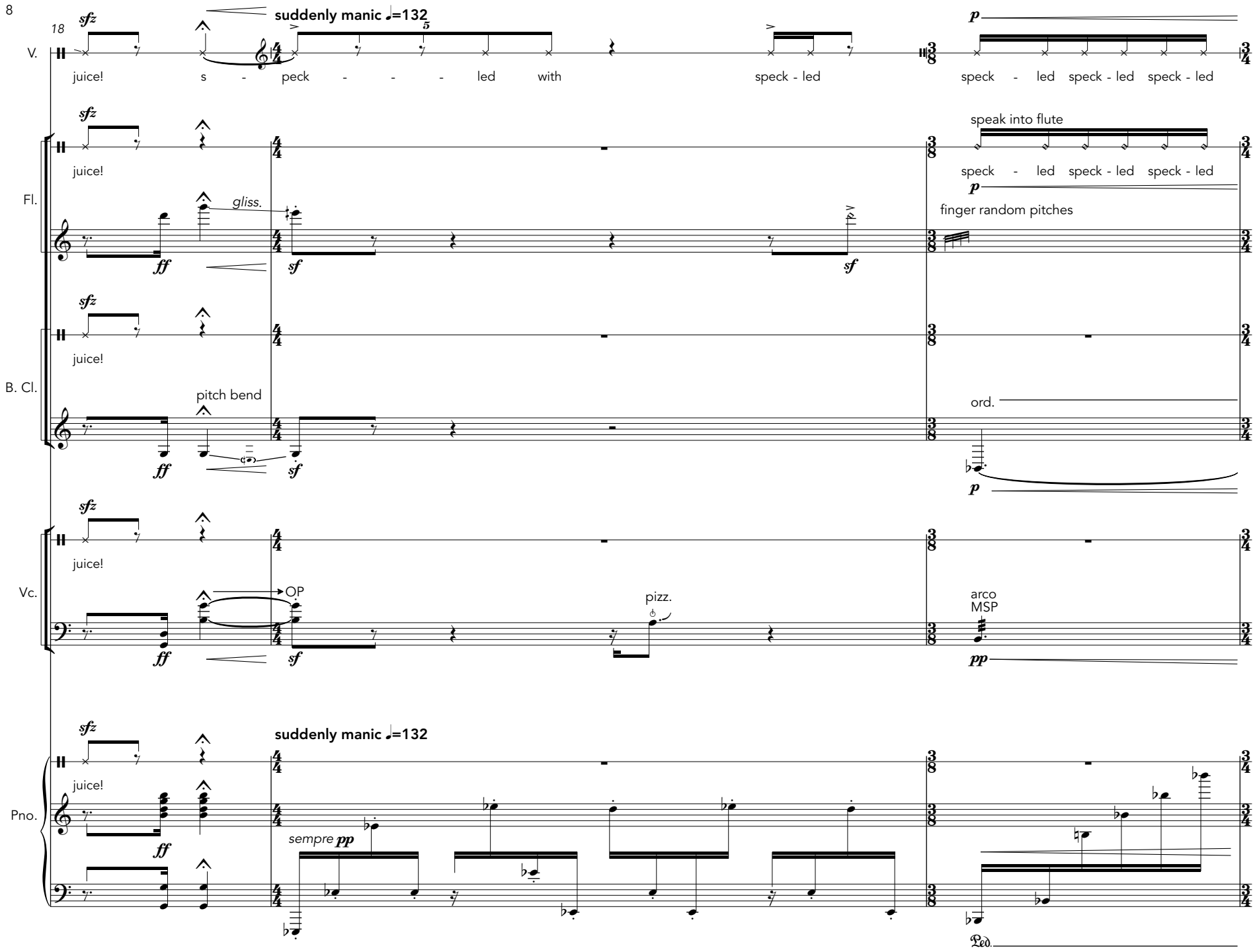
♩=124




each in their own tempo
15-20''
♩=124
mf mp etc. ad lib.
4
5
looking at clarinetist, conduct this bar and the following downbeat (as if giving an example)
V.
death (th)
sfz
juice!
mp
one, two, three,
Fl.
grips (s)
B. Cl.
confidently
a halved orange (zh)
wide, exaggerated vib.
bend
Vc.
made dew - y (ee)
pizz.
f
with its own (n)
*) turn head violently towards clarinetist and look angry -- as if they had made a mistake
Pno.


annoyed
rit.
♩=114
V.
juice!
death (th)
juice!
Oh, God! Just
drink your juice!
juice!
Fl.
ss
juice!
drink your juice!
juice!
pizz.
B. Cl.
juice!
orange (zh)
juice!
drink your juice!
bend
Vc.
S.T.
arco flautando
dew-y (ee)
juice!
drink your juice!
juice!
ord.
S.P
ord. wide vib.
rit.
♩=114
Pno.
own (n)
juice!
drink your juice!
juice!

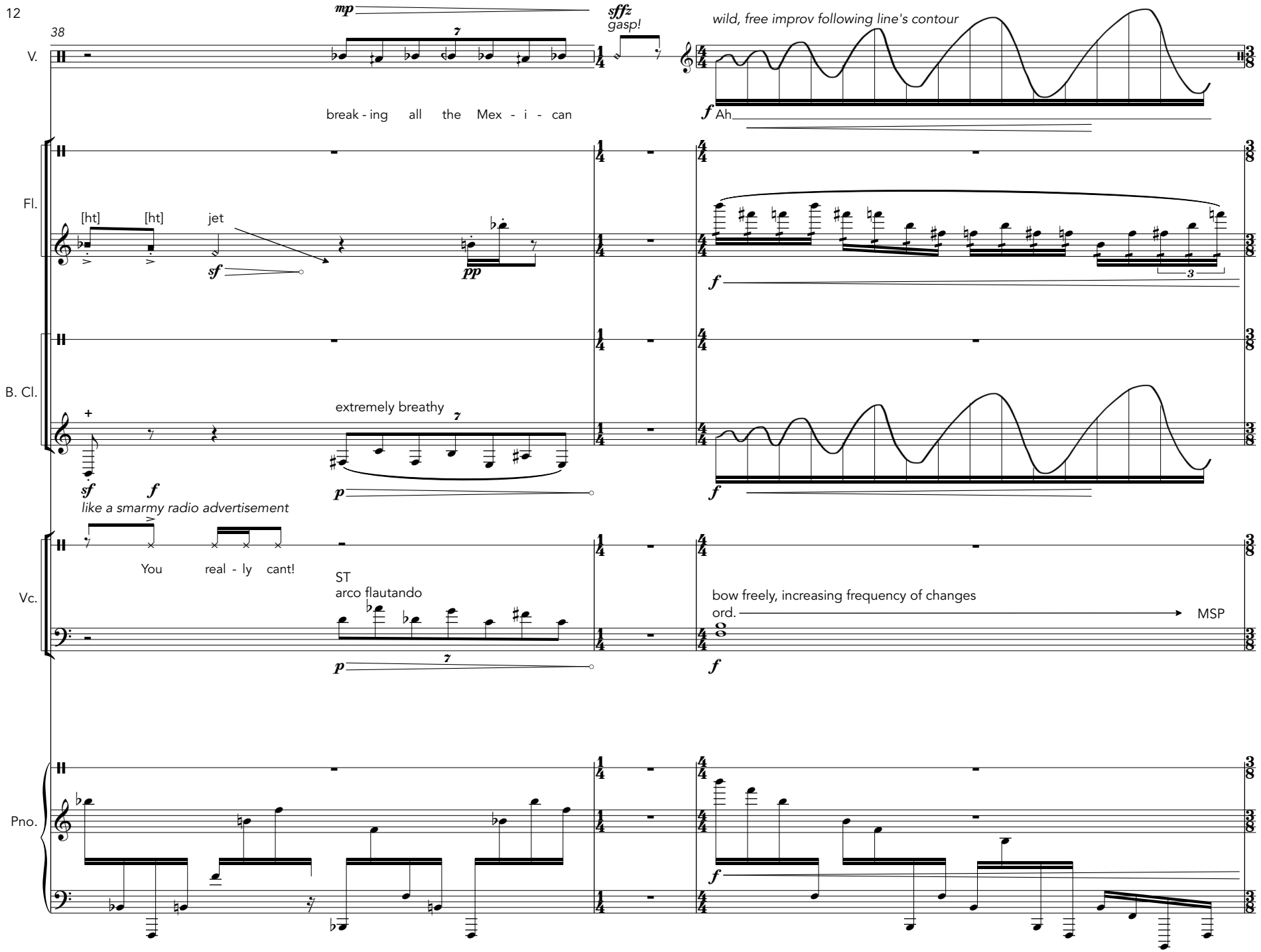

14
V.
sfz
juice!
one,
two,
juice!
one,
two,
three,
sub. p
orange
Fl.
juice!
sffz
flutter
sfp
mp
orange (zh)
B. Cl.
mp
sffz
Vc.
SP
ord.
mf
increase intensity of vib.
Pno.
pp
f

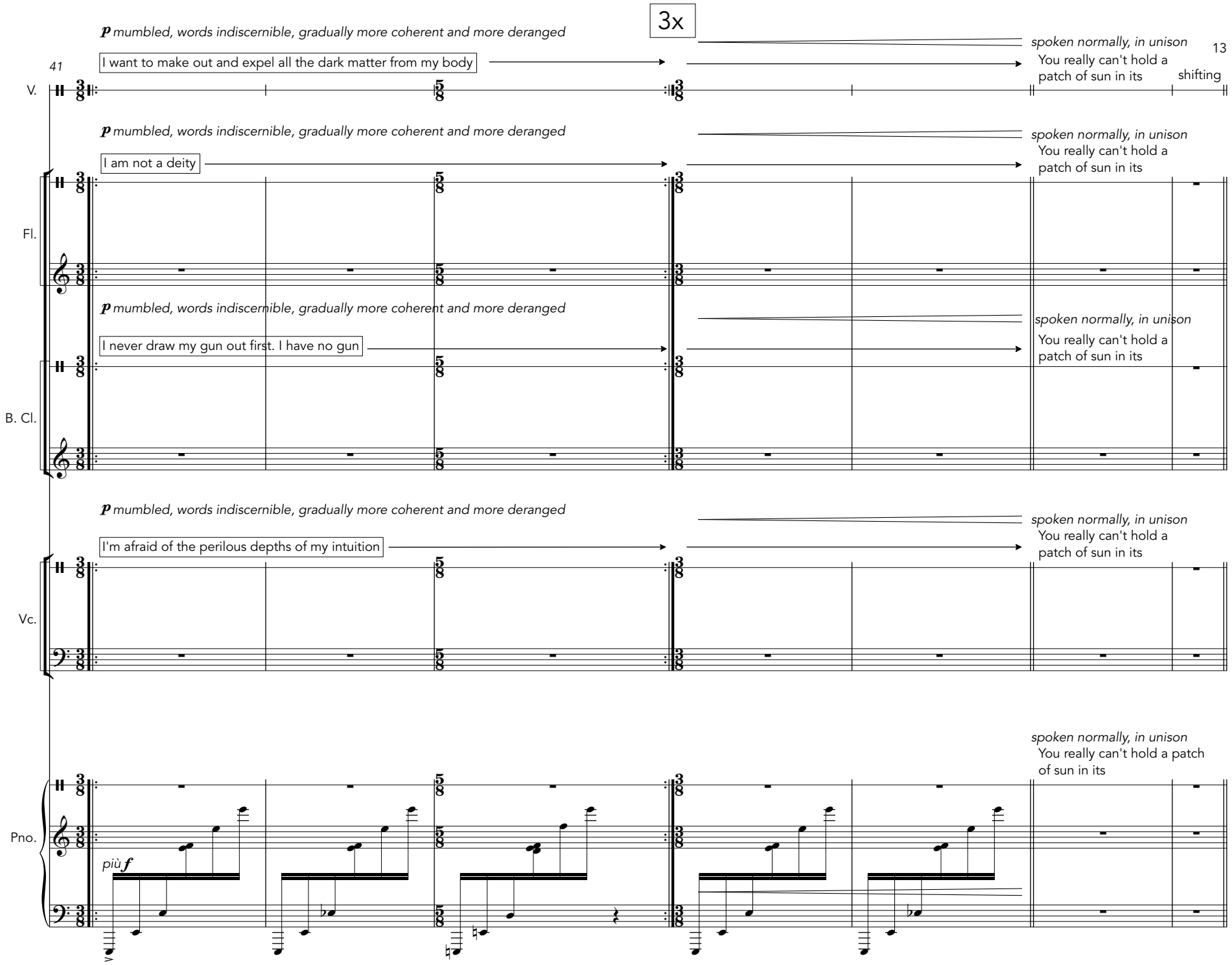

18
V.
sfz
suddenly manic ♩=132
5
juice!
s - peck - - - led with
speck - led
p
speck - led speck - led speck - led
Fl.
juice!
gliss.
ff
sf
speak into flute
speck - led speck - led speck - led
p
finger random pitches
B. Cl.
juice!
pitch bend
ord.
Vc.
juice!
OP
pizz.
arco
MSP
pp
Pno.
juice!
suddenly manic ♩=132
sempre pp
Ped.

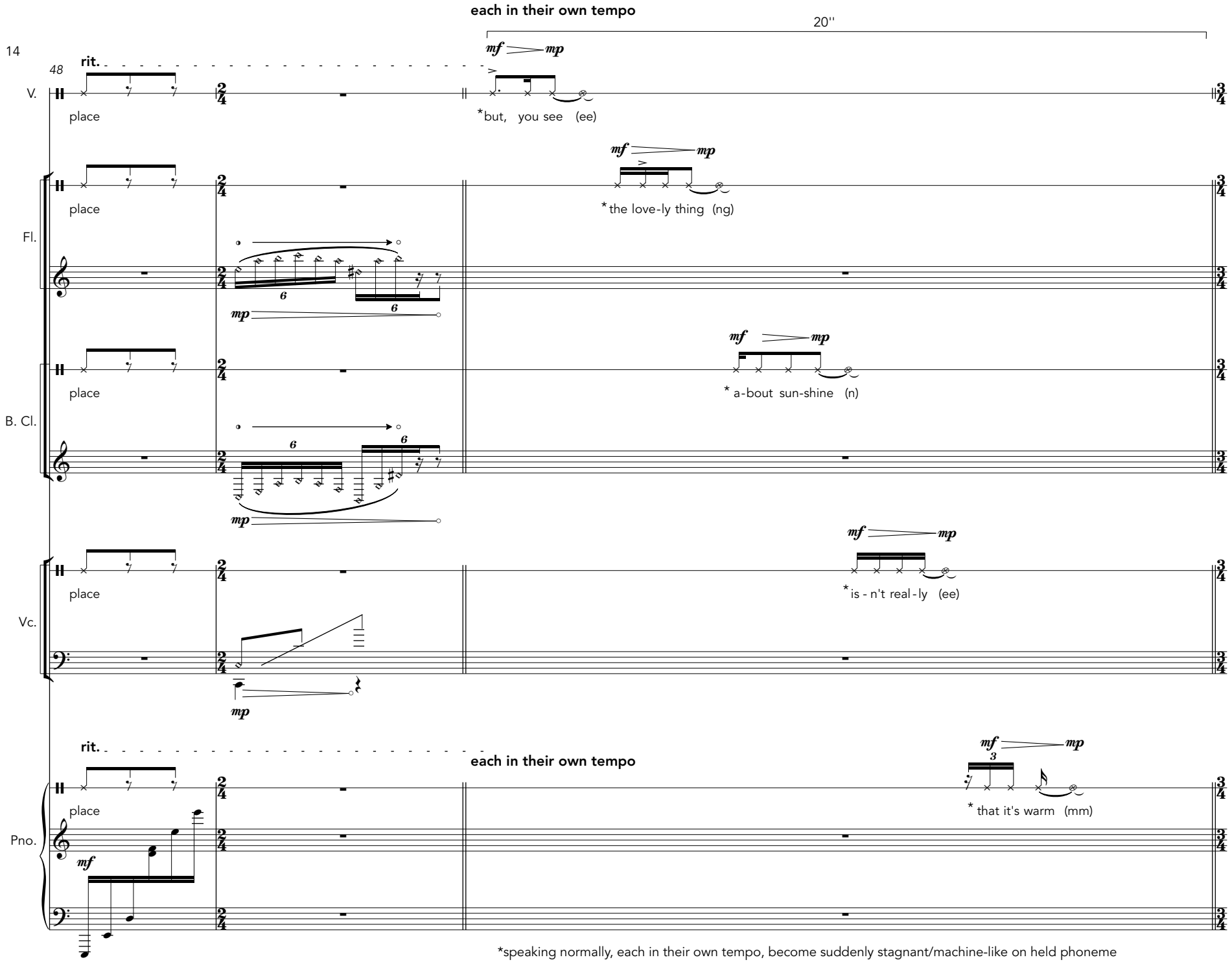

21
V.
Fl.
B. Cl.
Vc.
Pno.
speck - led with speck-led with speck-led with speck
lu - min - ous par - ti - tions of
vocal fry
flesh
(sh)
into flute
overblown
wild, free improv following contour of line
MSP
III, IV
pizz.


26
fragile
close lips percussively
more confident than before, fading in and out
V.
a spec - tre
s - - pec - tre break-ing all the
s - p
s - p
a spec - tre
gasp!
Fl.
[ht]
B. Cl.
slap tongue
Vc.
arco (ord.)
stop abruptly on the string
pizz.
S.T.
arco flautando
pizz.
arco
Pno.
sim.
sim.
Ped.

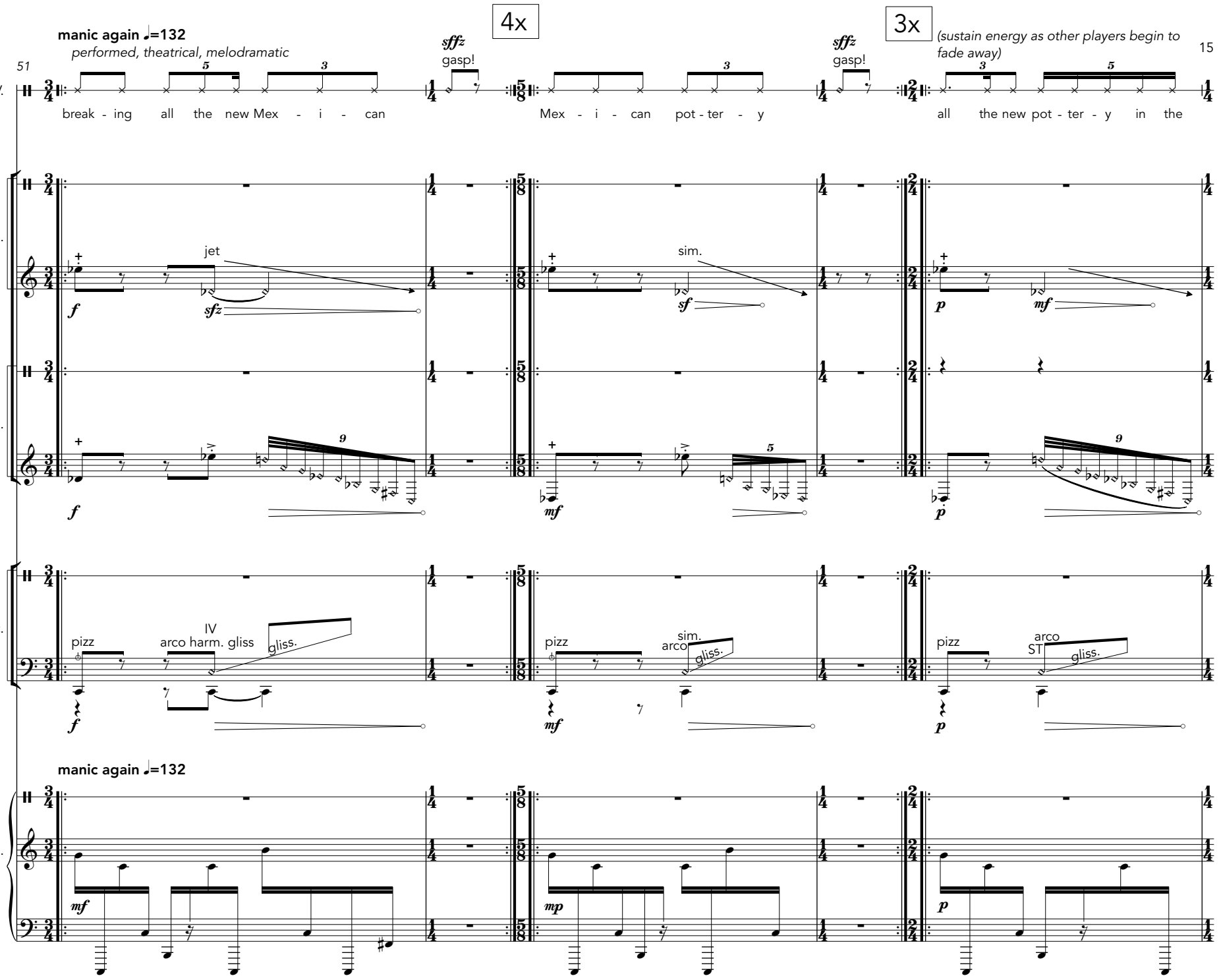

suddenly assertive, operatic
32
V.
a spec - tre
with percussive consonants
breaking all the pot ter - y
gliss.
disintigrating
a spec - tre
Fl.
whispered into instrument
speck-led with lu mi nous par ti tions of flesh
(sh)
rapid and random key clicks
B. Cl.
whispered
speck-led with lu mi nous par ti tions of flesh
(sh)
rapid and random key clicks
Vc.
harmonic gliss.
II.
whispered
speck-led with lu mi nous par ti tions of flesh
(sh)
flautando
SP
pizz.
Pno.
Ped.
Ped.

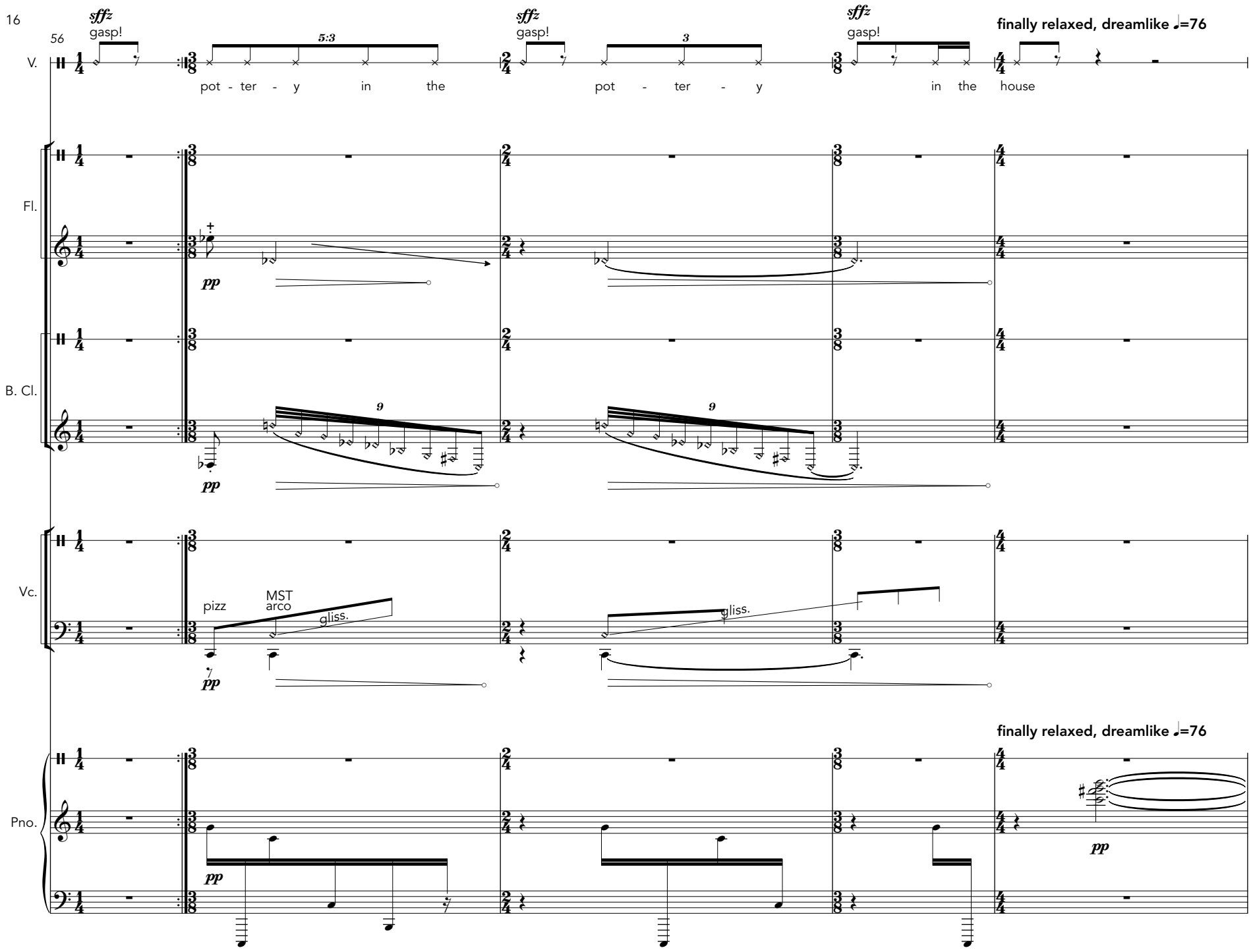

38
V.
mp
sffz
gasp!
wild, free improv following line's contour
break - ing all the Mex - i - can
f Ah
Fl.
[ht] [ht] jet
sf
pp
f
3
B. Cl.
extremely breathy
sf f
p
f
like a smarmy radio advertisement
Vc.
You real - ly cant!
ST
arco flautando
p
bow freely, increasing frequency of changes
ord.
MSP
f
Pno.
f

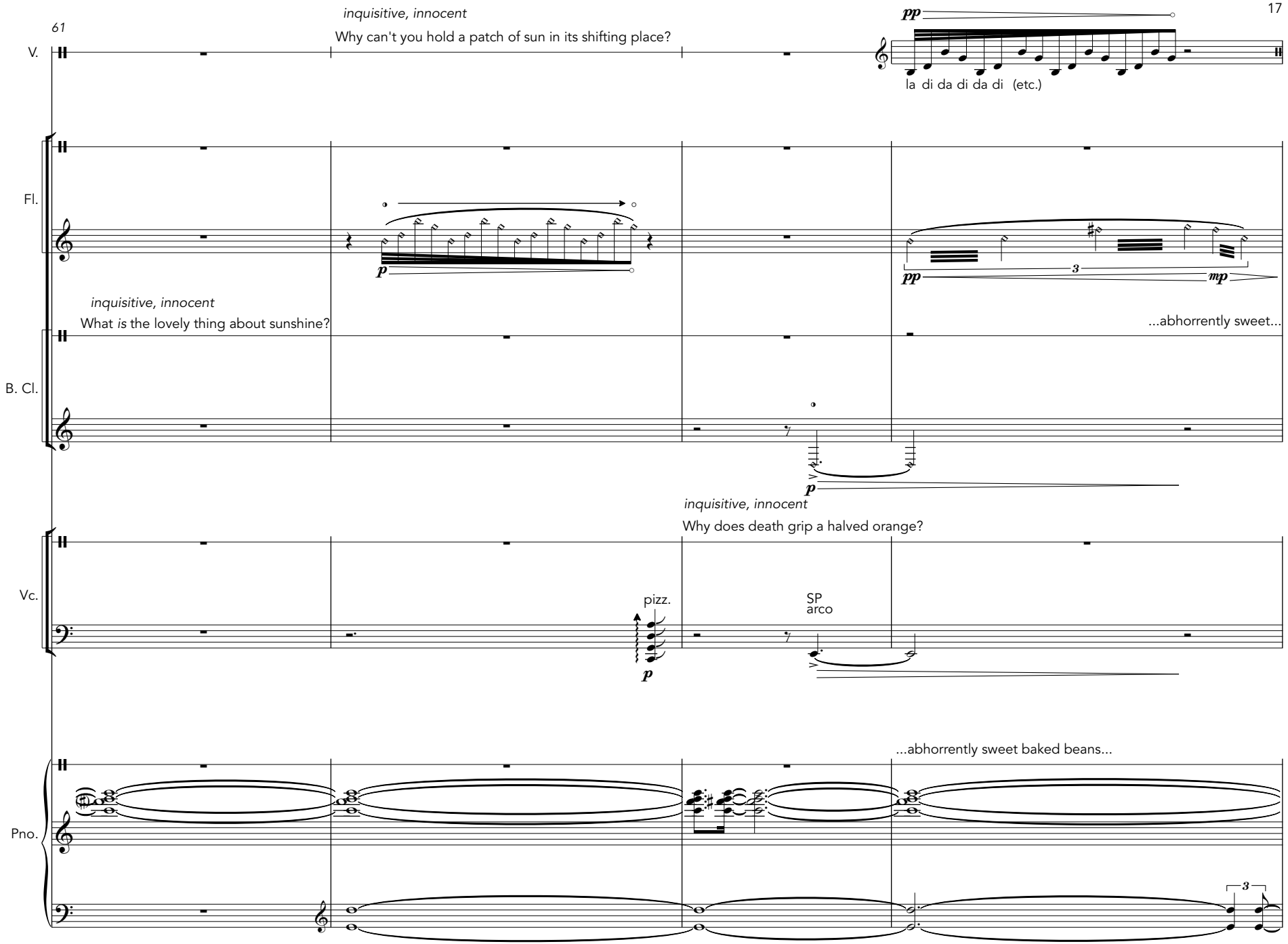

41
3x
V.
p mumbled, words indiscernible, gradually more coherent and more deranged
I want to make out and expel all the dark matter from my body
spoken normally, in unison
You really can't hold a patch of sun in its
shifting
Fl.
p mumbled, words indiscernible, gradually more coherent and more deranged
I am not a deity
spoken normally, in unison
You really can't hold a patch of sun in its
B. Cl.
p mumbled, words indiscernible, gradually more coherent and more deranged
I never draw my gun out first. I have no gun
spoken normally, in unison
You really can't hold a patch of sun in its
Vc.
p mumbled, words indiscernible, gradually more coherent and more deranged
I'm afraid of the perilous depths of my intuition
spoken normally, in unison
You really can't hold a patch of sun in its
Pno.
spoken normally, in unison
You really can't hold a patch of sun in its
più f



*speaking normally, each in their own tempo, become suddenly stagnant/machine-like on held phoneme
stagger breathe for remaining time, exaggerating breaths (almost like gasps)


51
manic again ♩=132
performed, theatrical, melodramatic
4x
3x
(sustain energy as other players begin to fade away)
sffz
gasp!
V.
break - ing all the new Mex - i - can
Mex - i - can pot - ter - y
all the new pot - ter - y in the
Fl.
B. Cl.
Vc.
Pno.
jet
sim.
pizz
arco harm. gliss
IV
gliss.
arco
ST
manic again ♩=132


56
sffz
gasp!
5:3
sffz
gasp!
3
sffz
gasp!
finally relaxed, dreamlike ♩=76
V.
pot - ter - y in the pot - ter - y in the house
Fl.
pp
B. Cl.
9
9
pp
Vc.
pizz
MST
arco
gliss.
gliss.
pp
finally relaxed, dreamlike ♩=76
Pno.
pp
pp


61
V.
inquisitive, innocent
Why can't you hold a patch of sun in its shifting place?
pp
la di da di da di (etc.)
Fl.
p
pp
3
mp
inquisitive, innocent
What is the lovely thing about sunshine?
...abhorrently sweet...
B. Cl.
p
inquisitive, innocent
Why does death grip a halved orange?
Vc.
pizz.
p
SP
arco
...abhorrently sweet baked beans...
Pno.
3

65

V.

mp pp 5

sh sh sh sh sh

...abhorrently sweet baked beans...

p

hmm

you_

...a halved orange speckled with...

: ...abhorrently sweet baked beans... :

mp pp 5

sh sh sh sh sh

Fl.

p

rapid and random key clicks

mf pp 5

...heavy chalk outline around the bulk of it all...

: ...abhorrently sweet baked beans... :

mp pp 5

sh sh sh sh sh

B. Cl.

pp

rapid and random key clicks

mf pp 5

...primordial jungle juice...

...the dark matter from my body...

: ...abhorrently sweet baked beans... :

Vc.

ord.
non vib.

mp 5 pp

p

MST

pp mp

pizz.

p

pp

: ...abhorrently sweet baked beans... :

Pno.

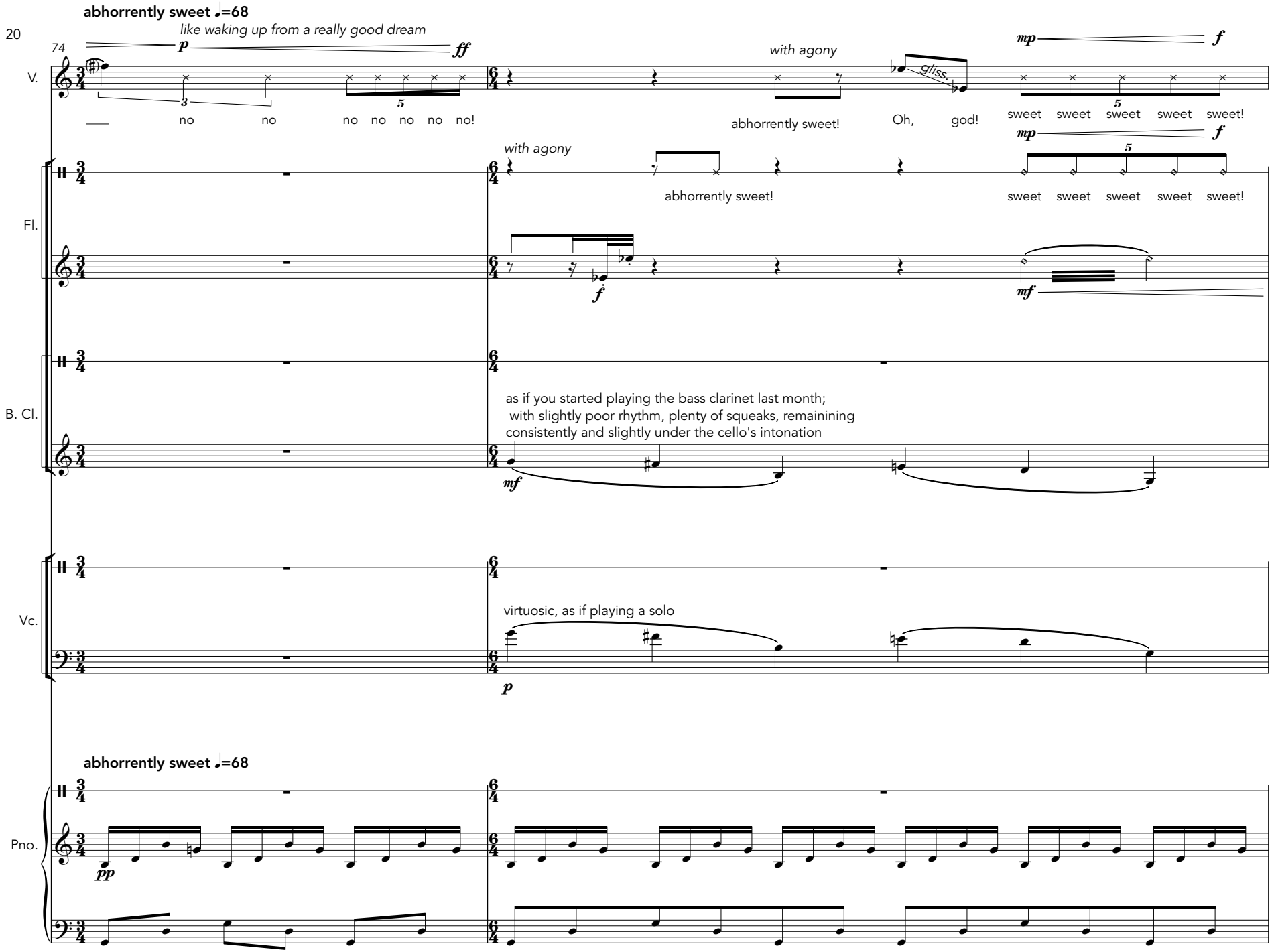
3

3

3

*repeat phrase until end of bar


rubato ♩=64
cool, nonchalant
70
mf
molto rit.
V.
can grow
out of a smat-ter - ing
a smat - ter - ing of
freck - les
p whispered, not in unison
...a jazzy apparition...
Fl.
B. Cl.
Vc.
arco
ord.
ST
Pno.
obnoxious cocktail music
mp
sub. p


abhorrently sweet ♩=68
74
like waking up from a really good dream
p
ff
V.
no no no no no no no!
with agony
gliss.
abhorrently sweet!
Oh, god!
mp
f
sweet sweet sweet sweet sweet!
Fl.
with agony
abhorrently sweet!
sweet sweet sweet sweet sweet!
f
mf
B. Cl.
as if you started playing the bass clarinet last month;
with slightly poor rhythm, plenty of squeaks, remainining
consistently and slightly under the cello's intonation
mf
Vc.
virtuosic, as if playing a solo
p
abhorrently sweet ♩=68
Pno.
pp


76
V.
vocal fry
singsong, pitch/rhythm not exact
mockingly (sing exact pitches as they enter your range)
with growing exasperation
Ugh!_
I'd ra - ther die!
I am a cel - list who is ve - ry an-noy- ing!!
ba - by,
Fl.
vocal fry
singsong, into flute, pitch/ rhythm not exact
Ugh!_
sweet!
abhorrently sweet!
I'd ra - ther die!
B. Cl.
Vc.
Pno.



*if audience begins to laugh here (as they probably will), stop playing, all players turn towards audience and look glaringly until laughter stops—this might be an exceedingly uncomfortable period of time—then begin again

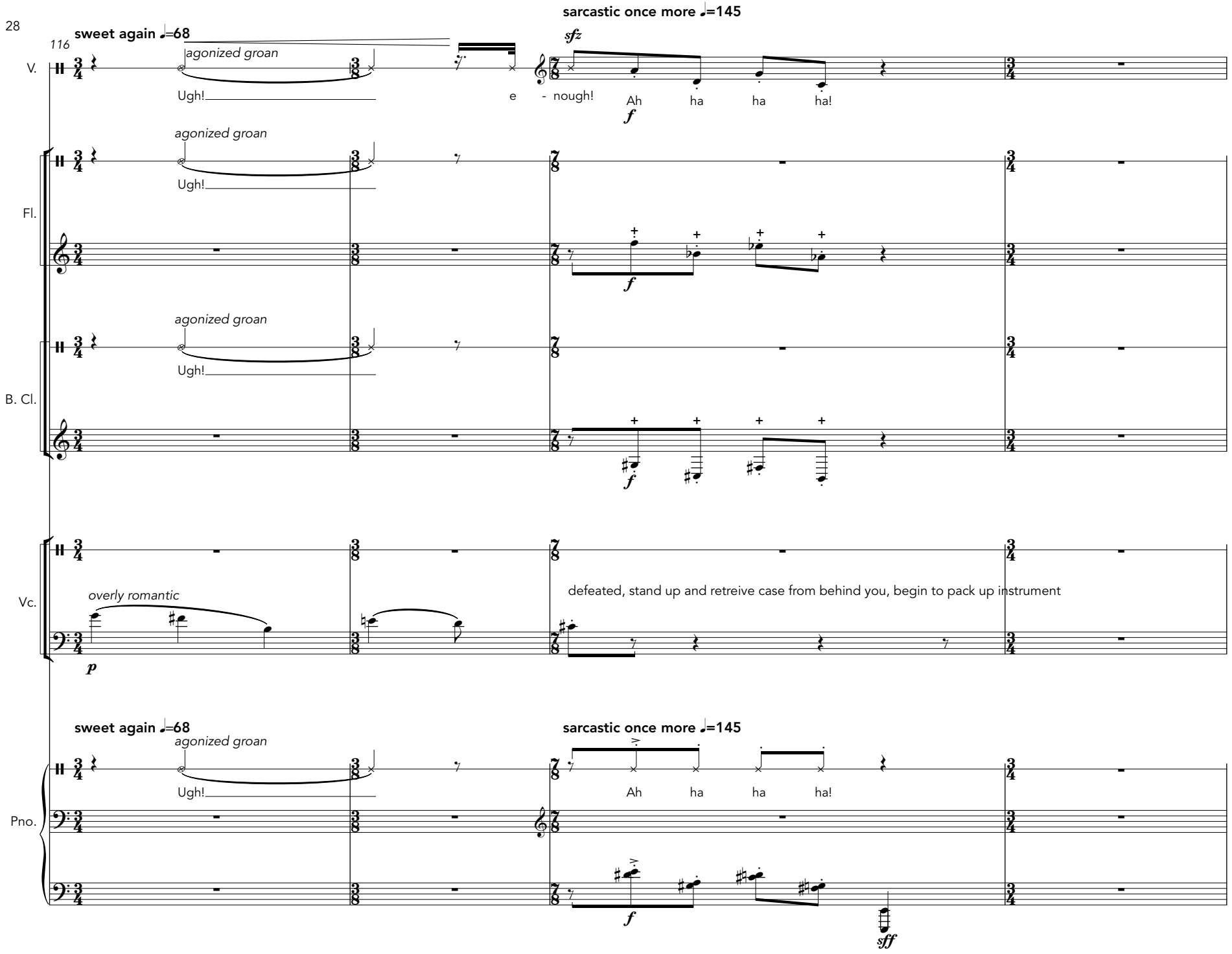

86
V.
moon - light
In - di - go moon - light
f
jun-gle juice,
jun-gle juice
pri-
Fl.
sff
HYAH!!
f
B. Cl.
sff
HYAH!!
f
Vc.
gliss.
f
Pno.
ff
f

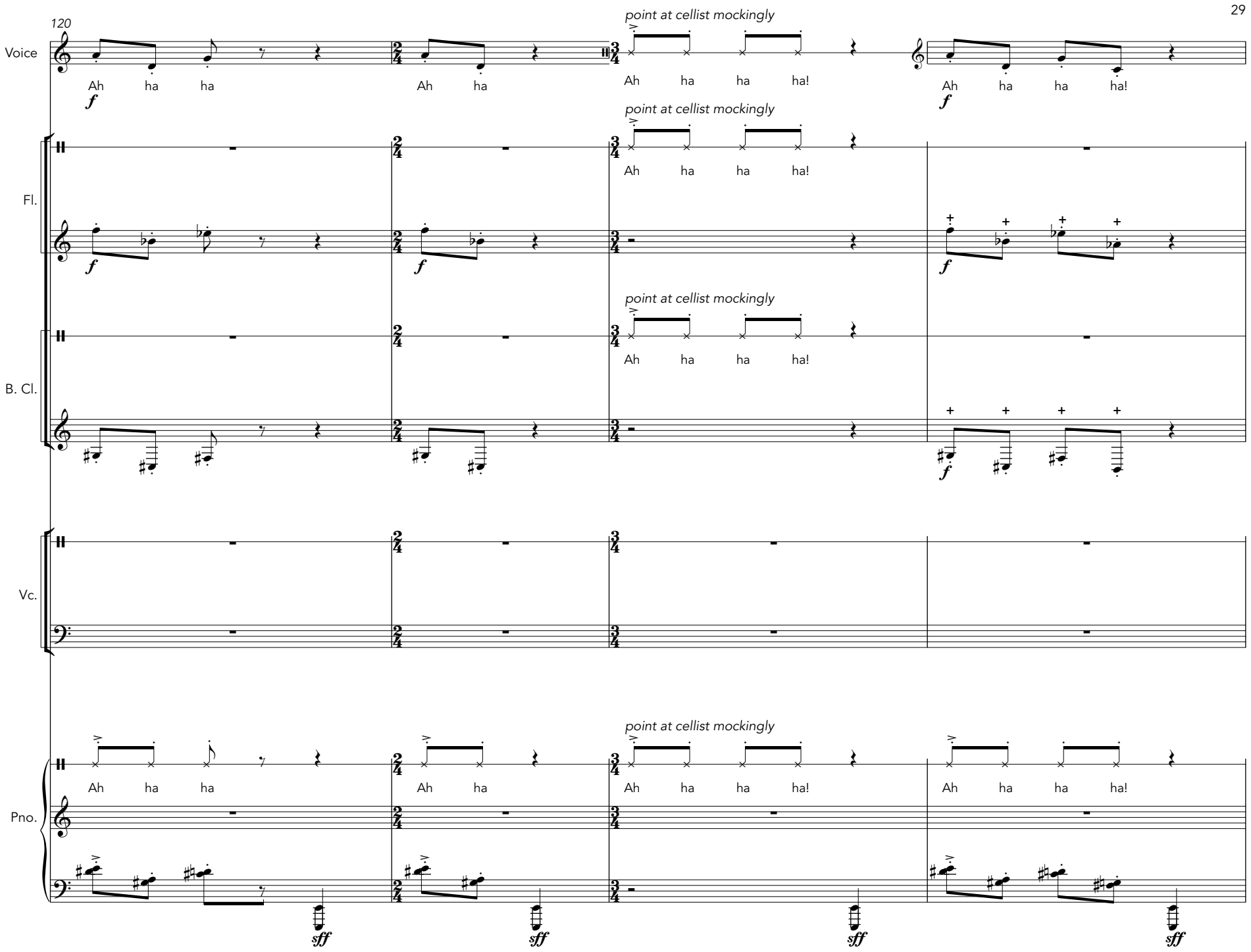

92
V.
mor-di - al
jun-gle juice
In - di - go
jun-gle juice
ff
In - di - go!
Fl.
tr
B. Cl.
tr
Vc.
gliss.
Pno.

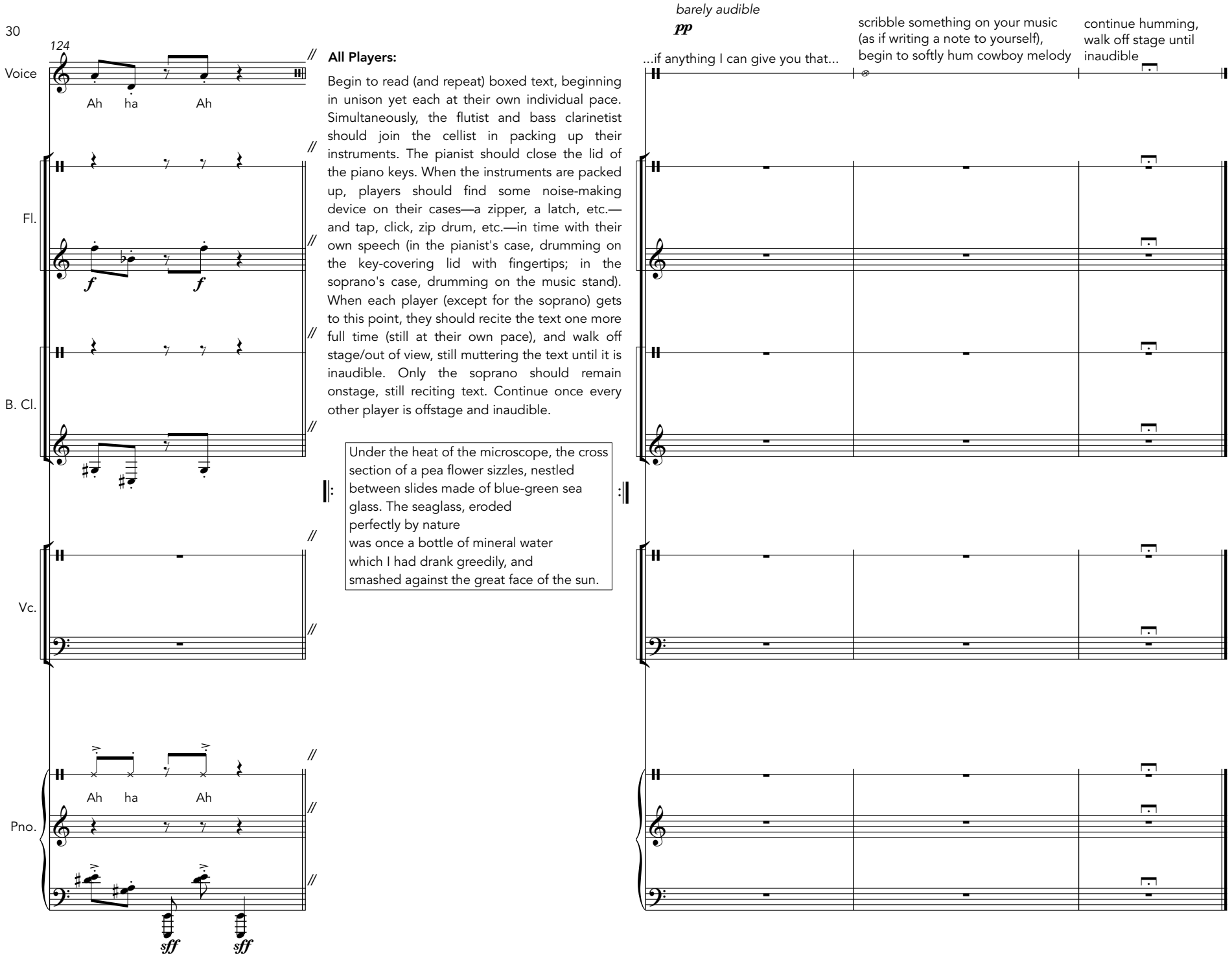

98
V.
Fl.
B. Cl.
Vc.
Pno.
mp
7
*
*hold for an obscenely long time, taking multiple (staggered) breaths, looking at other players, panicked and angry, as if everyone is waiting for someone to cut them off. Fade out anticlimactically when the pianist begins to speak
After 10 seconds, walk nonchalantly/ distractedly to close lid of piano
still distractedly, walking back to sit on the piano bench
...you see, the lovely thing about sunshine isn't really that it's warm, but rather that it frames everything so harmonically...


102
sarcastic ♩=145
same as before ♩=124
conduct again
sarcastic ♩=145
like a bad child actor in a made-for-TV movie
V.
Ah ha ha ha!
one, two, three, juice!
Ah ha ha ha!
like a really bad stand-up comedian
Ah ha ha ha!
I never draw my gun out first
Have I told you the one about the sea glass?
Fl.
juice!
Can we try juice again?
B. Cl.
juice!
lose yourself in laughter
Vc.
Ah ha ha ha!
juice!
Ah ha ha ha!
Ah ha ha ha ha ha!
sarcastic ♩=145
same as before ♩=124
sarcastic ♩=145
lose yourself in laughter
Pno.
tone cluster


109
V.
Fl.
B. Cl.
Vc.
Pno.
spoken in unison
I have no gun.
Ah ha ha ha!
(nn)
pointilist, as fast as possible without overlap
do
you
want
my
song?
seductively
my... lyricism?
f
sff


sweet again ♩=68
116
agonized groan
Ugh!
e - nough!
sarcastic once more ♩=145
sfz
Ah ha ha ha!
f
V.
Fl.
B. Cl.
Vc.
Pno.
overly romantic
p
defeated, stand up and retreive case from behind you, begin to pack up instrument
sff


120
Voice
Fl.
B. Cl.
Vc.
Pno.
Ah ha ha
Ah ha
Ah ha ha ha!
point at cellist mockingly
f
sff



All Players:

Begin to read (and repeat) boxed text, beginning in unison yet each at their own individual pace. Simultaneously, the flutist and bass clarinetist should join the cellist in packing up their instruments. The pianist should close the lid of the piano keys. When the instruments are packed up, players should find some noise-making device on their cases—a zipper, a latch, etc.—and tap, click, zip drum, etc.—in time with their own speech (in the pianist's case, drumming on the key-covering lid with fingertips; in the soprano's case, drumming on the music stand). When each player (except for the soprano) gets to this point, they should recite the text one more full time (still at their own pace), and walk off stage/out of view, still muttering the text until it is inaudible. Only the soprano should remain onstage, still reciting text. Continue once every other player is offstage and inaudible.

Under the heat of the microscope, the cross
section of a pea flower sizzles, nestled
between slides made of blue-green sea
glass. The seaglass, eroded
perfectly by nature
was once a bottle of mineral water
which I had drank greedily, and
smashed against the great face of the sun.